Banking requirements | core catalogue

Research baseline for cross-bank capability design and QA planning • Research cut-off: 22 Oct 2026 • Tailor legal obligations to licence, product, customer segment and jurisdiction.

Purpose	Reusable starting point for requirements decomposition, traceability and risk-based QA planning.
Scope	Universal capabilities are foundational banking functions. Global baseline items reflect broadly applicable supervisory or industry standards, often risk- or size-proportionate. Jurisdiction/product-specific rules are kept in the India examples tab.
What “common” means	Common capability does not mean identical implementation or a single law applying everywhere. Basel Core Principles are minimum supervisory standards for sound banking supervision; FATF standards are implemented by countries through local frameworks.
Priority	P1 = essential to safe operation, customer funds, accurate books, or legal control. P2 = important control/service capability. P3 = conditional/enhancement; validate scope before committing. Priority is a QA planning judgment, not a legal classification.
Applicability	Universal capability = expected for a deposit-taking bank in some form. Global baseline / proportional = design against supervisory standards with proportionality. Conditional = required only for selected products, markets, channels, or risk profiles.
How to use for QA	Filter by category, priority or applicability. Convert each statement into system-level requirements, rules, roles, limits, SLAs and data definitions. Add product/jurisdiction rules, acceptance thresholds, expected outcomes and trace links to stories/controls.
QA coverage prompt	For each applicable requirement, identify positive, negative, boundary, duplicate/replay, concurrency, timeout/failure, permission/SoD, reconciliation, audit-trail, resilience and recovery cases where relevant.
Evidence fields	Each core entry includes a concise test focus and source IDs. Sources tab records primary authority, scope caveat and direct source link. India examples are illustrative, not exhaustive legal advice.
Maintenance	Re-check links and live regulatory texts before release or control attestation. Regulatory updates, local transposition, thresholds and commencement dates can change. This research is a baseline, not a compliance opinion.

Core banking requirements

Core capabilities distilled from supervisory principles, AML/CFT standards and banking operating practice. Source IDs resolve in Sources; applicability flags prevent treating every item as universally mandated.

Requirement ID	Category	Requirement statement	Priority	Applicability class	QA test focus / candidate evidence	Source IDs
GOV-01	Governance & control	The bank shall maintain approved governance, delegated authority, accountability and policy controls for each material banking activity.	P1	Global baseline / proportional	Validate approved policy/version, owner, delegation boundaries, exception path, review dates and evidence of governance approval.	BCP24; OPR21
GOV-02	Governance & control	The bank shall enforce segregation of duties for conflicting activities (including initiation, approval, execution, custody and reconciliation) and detect/record approved overrides.	P1	Global baseline / proportional	Exercise conflicting role combinations, maker-checker bypass attempts, emergency access, expiry and immutable override audit.	BCP24; OPR21
GOV-03	Governance & control	The bank shall maintain independent compliance, risk and audit control functions with access to records needed to assess control effectiveness.	P2	Global baseline / proportional	Test read access, evidence completeness, issue tracking, remediation workflow and independence boundaries.	BCP24
CUS-01	Customer & account lifecycle	The bank shall establish and maintain a unique customer identity record and link customer parties to accounts, products, mandates and relationships.	P1	Universal capability	Test duplicate detection, merged/split records, aliases, joint parties, legal entities, linkage integrity and data correction history.	BCP24; FATF
CUS-02	Customer & account lifecycle	The bank shall capture customer due-diligence information required by its risk policy and applicable law before enabling the relevant relationship or service.	P1	Global baseline / proportional	Test required/optional fields by customer type and risk, incomplete onboarding, verification failure, restricted/conditional account states.	FATF; RBI-KYC
CUS-03	Customer & account lifecycle	The bank shall record customer consent, disclosures, terms acceptance, communication preferences and effective dates where required for the service.	P1	Conditional by product/jurisdiction	Test versioned terms, withdrawal/change of consent, channel evidence, timestamp, language and downstream suppression.	BCP24; RBI-DIGPAY
CUS-04	Customer & account lifecycle	The bank shall support controlled account opening, maintenance, restrictions, dormancy/inactivity handling and closure with valid authority and status transitions.	P1	Universal capability	Test permitted state transitions, blocked transactions, holds, closure with pending items, reopening rules and reason/audit record.	BCP24
CUS-05	Customer & account lifecycle	The bank shall maintain authorized signatories, beneficiaries, mandates, powers and limits, and apply them to each relevant transaction.	P1	Universal capability	Test mandate scope, expiry, revocation, multiple approvers, transaction-specific limits and stale authority.	BCP24
DEP-01	Deposits & balances	The bank shall maintain accurate account balances and available-balance calculations from posted entries, holds, value dates and configured overdraft/credit rules.	P1	Universal capability	Reconcile opening + credits - debits ± adjustments; test holds, value dates, overdrafts, concurrent postings and precision.	BCP24
DEP-02	Deposits & balances	The bank shall apply product terms for interest, fees, minimum balances, rates, accruals and waivers consistently and reproducibly.	P1	Universal capability	Boundary-test rate tiers, effective dates, day-count convention, leap years, rounding, fee waiver and retroactive correction.	BCP24
DEP-03	Deposits & balances	The bank shall provide customers with periodic account information showing transactions, balances, fees and other disclosures required by the product and local rules.	P1	Universal capability	Check statement completeness, ordering, opening/closing balance, reversals, fee disclosure, period boundaries and delivery preference.	BCP24
PAY-01	Payments & transfers	The bank shall validate payment instructions for required data, authority, limits, account status, available funds and applicable routing rules before execution.	P1	Universal capability	Test malformed/missing data, blocked account, insufficient funds, limits, invalid route, duplicate instruction and rejection reason.	BCP24; ISO22
PAY-02	Payments & transfers	The bank shall track each payment through defined lifecycle states and preserve an end-to-end reference for inquiry, investigation and reconciliation.	P1	Universal capability	Test accepted, pending, settled, rejected, returned, cancelled and timed-out paths; ensure one traceable reference across systems.	BCP24; ISO22
PAY-03	Payments & transfers	The bank shall prevent unintended duplicate execution and safely handle retries, timeouts and replayed messages using idempotency or equivalent controls.	P1	Universal capability	Replay same instruction/message under retries, concurrent requests and uncertain response; verify single financial effect and consistent status.	OPR21; ISO22
PAY-04	Payments & transfers	The bank shall reconcile internal payment records with settlement, clearing, correspondent or external processor records and resolve breaks within defined controls.	P1	Universal capability	Test matched/unmatched/partial/late/duplicate records, cutoff boundaries, suspense aging, ownership and evidence of closure.	BCP24; OPR21
PAY-05	Payments & transfers	The bank shall process reversals, returns, failed payments and customer remediation according to scheme rules, contracts and applicable local timelines.	P1	Conditional by rail/jurisdiction	Test return reason mapping, partial reversal, value date, compensation/interest, repeat failure and deadline escalation.	BCP24; RBI-FAIL
LND-01	Credit & lending	Where lending is offered, the bank shall capture an authorized credit decision based on documented eligibility, affordability/risk criteria, limits and delegated authority.	P1	Conditional by product	Test policy boundaries, missing/invalid inputs, exception approval, override logging, authority limits and adverse/decline outcome.	CREDIT; BCP24
LND-02	Credit & lending	Where lending is offered, the bank shall maintain contractual loan terms, repayment schedules, disbursements, accruals, fees, delinquency and payoff balances accurately.	P1	Conditional by product	Test schedule generation, prepayment, partial payment, arrears, rate reset, repricing, holiday calendar, payoff quote and rounding.	CREDIT; BCP24
LND-03	Credit & lending	The bank shall monitor credit exposures and overdue obligations, apply authorized collections/forbearance actions and preserve a complete decision and payment history.	P1	Conditional by product	Test exposure aggregation, delinquency thresholds, cure/roll logic, collection permissions, promise-to-pay, restructure and audit history.	CREDIT
FIN-01	Financial records	The bank shall maintain a complete, balanced and traceable general ledger with controlled posting rules linking operational events to accounting entries.	P1	Universal capability	Verify debit=credit, account mapping, control totals, event-to-journal lineage, posting date/value date and unauthorized manual journal.	BCP24; OPR21
FIN-02	Financial records	The bank shall support controlled period close, suspense management, adjustments and reconciliation of material accounts and operational subledgers.	P1	Universal capability	Test close cutoffs, late postings, unresolved breaks, duplicate journals, approval chain, reopen/adjustment trail and reconciliation evidence.	BCP24
RISK-01	Risk, AML & compliance	The bank shall apply a risk-based AML/CFT control process including customer risk assessment, monitoring, alert handling and escalation as required by local implementation of FATF standards.	P1	Global baseline; local implementation	Test rule scenarios, thresholds/versioning, alert generation, triage, case closure, escalation, false positives and auditability.	FATF; RBI-KYC
RISK-02	Risk, AML & compliance	The bank shall screen customers, relevant parties and transactions against applicable sanctions/prohibition lists and enforce match disposition controls.	P1	Jurisdiction & exposure dependent	Test exact/fuzzy matches, list updates, name variants, false positive release authorization, blocked/frozen outcomes and list version evidence.	FATF; RBI-KYC
RISK-03	Risk, AML & compliance	The bank shall retain customer, account and transaction records for the legally required period and retrieve them in a timely, complete and secure manner.	P1	Global baseline; retention is local	Test retention starts/ends, legal holds, deletion prohibition, retrieval completeness, permissions and reconstruction of a transaction.	FATF; RBI-KYC
RISK-04	Risk, AML & compliance	The bank shall calculate, monitor and report material financial and non-financial risks using governed data, limits, thresholds and escalation paths.	P1	Global baseline / proportional	Test risk aggregation across entities/products, limit breach, stale/missing data, stress/reporting cutoff, escalation and traceability to source.	BCP24; BCBS239; OPR21
DATA-01	Data & reporting	The bank shall maintain accurate, complete and timely source data with ownership, validation rules, lineage and controlled corrections for material banking records.	P1	Global baseline / proportional	Inject missing, duplicate, stale and invalid data; verify quarantine/correction, source lineage, reconciliations and downstream impact.	BCBS239; BCP24
DATA-02	Data & reporting	The bank shall produce customer, management, financial and regulatory reports from controlled definitions and retain evidence of source, transformation and submission.	P1	Universal capability; report set is local	Compare report to ledger/source totals; test cutoff, restatement, mapping version, rejected submission and resubmission audit trail.	BCP24; BCBS239
SEC-01	Security & access	The bank shall authenticate users and customers using controls appropriate to the channel and risk, and authorize access according to least privilege and role.	P1	Universal capability	Test valid/invalid credentials, MFA/step-up triggers, session expiry, lockout, role matrix, privilege escalation and access revocation.	BCP24; OPR21; RBI-DIGPAY
SEC-02	Security & access	The bank shall protect sensitive customer, credential and transaction data in transit and at rest, and limit collection, use and disclosure to authorized purposes.	P1	Universal capability; privacy rules local	Verify masking, encryption/configuration evidence, access logging, data export controls, secrets handling and least-data use.	BCP24; OPR21; RBI-DIGPAY
SEC-03	Security & access	The bank shall log security-relevant and financially material actions in tamper-resistant records sufficient for investigation and audit.	P1	Universal capability	Test actor, timestamp, object, before/after, source, correlation ID, failed actions, clock consistency, privilege limits and log tampering detection.	BCP24; OPR21
SEC-04	Security & access	The bank shall detect, investigate and respond to fraud, cyber threats and anomalous transactions, with controlled customer protection and incident escalation.	P1	Universal capability; local controls may vary	Test detection scenarios, alert latency, case lifecycle, account/card blocking, customer notification, false-positive review and incident evidence.	OPR21; RBI-DIGPAY; RBI-UNAUTH
OPS-01	Operations & resilience	The bank shall monitor critical services and transaction processing, detect failures and communicate accurate service/transaction status to affected users and operators.	P1	Universal capability	Simulate service outage, queue backlog, partial processing, stale status, monitoring failure and recovery notification.	OPR21; BCP24
OPS-02	Operations & resilience	The bank shall maintain and test recovery and continuity arrangements for critical banking operations, including defined dependencies and recovery objectives.	P1	Global baseline / proportional	Exercise failover, restore from backup, dependency outage, data-loss bounds, reconciliation after recovery and evidence of periodic testing.	OPR21; BCP24
OPS-03	Operations & resilience	The bank shall control changes to products, rates, rules, interfaces and software through risk assessment, approval, testing, release and rollback procedures.	P1	Universal capability	Test unauthorized change, approval separation, version activation, rollback, in-flight transaction behavior and post-release checks.	OPR21; BCP24
OPS-04	Operations & resilience	The bank shall assess critical third-party dependencies and maintain appropriate oversight, continuity arrangements and exit/contingency plans.	P2	Global baseline / proportional	Test provider outage, data access/export, SLA/incident escalation, subcontractor dependency, alternate processing and exit data completeness.	OPR21; BCP24
CX-01	Customer service & disputes	The bank shall provide customers with accessible channels to request service, report errors/fraud, raise complaints and receive referenceable status and outcomes.	P1	Universal capability; service rules local	Test intake channels, acknowledgment, case ID, accessibility, routing, status changes, duplicate complaint handling and closure evidence.	BCP24; RBI-OMB; RBI-GRIEV
CX-02	Customer service & disputes	The bank shall investigate transaction disputes using retrievable transaction, authentication, communication and decision evidence, and apply authorized corrections/remedies.	P1	Universal capability; remedies/timelines local	Test customer-not-present/card-present scenarios, evidence completeness, decision trace, provisional credit, final adjustment and notifications.	BCP24; RBI-UNAUTH
INT-01	Interfaces & interoperability	Where external rails or partners are used, the bank shall validate, securely exchange and reconcile messages against the applicable network/interface specification.	P1	Conditional by rail/market	Test schema/version validation, code lists, character sets, duplicate IDs, invalid signatures, partial responses and backward-compatible changes.	ISO22; BCP24
PROD-01	Product & pricing	The bank shall configure products, rates, fees, limits, eligibility and disclosures as versioned effective-dated rules, with approval and impact controls.	P1	Universal capability	Test effective-date boundary, overlapping rules, new-vs-existing customers, rollback, disclosure alignment and unapproved config changes.	BCP24; CREDIT

India | illustrative regulatory examples

Examples to localize the core catalogue. They are deliberately separate from the cross-bank baseline; confirm current consolidated text, entity coverage and amendments before test sign-off.

Example ID	Topic	Requirement / regulatory example	Applicability note	Primary source / instrument	QA test focus	Source IDs
IN-KYC-01	Customer due diligence	RBI KYC Direction applies to RBI-regulated entities; implement customer acceptance, risk management, identification, due diligence, ongoing due diligence and recordkeeping as applicable.	RBI-regulated entities; exact obligations depend on entity and customer case.	PMLA/PML Rules; RBI KYC Direction (RBI master-directions listing updated through 14 Aug 2025)	Test individual/legal-entity onboarding, beneficial-owner capture, risk category, periodic update triggers and audit evidence.	RBI-KYC
IN-KYC-02	KYC channels	Where V-CIP is used, implement the RBI-prescribed consent, live interaction, official verification, secure recording, timestamps and operator controls.	Only if bank uses V-CIP; detailed conditions apply.	RBI KYC Direction; 2020 V-CIP amendment incorporated in consolidated direction	Test consent, liveness/interaction failure, operator authorization, recording retrieval, timestamp and redaction controls.	RBI-KYC
IN-DIG-01	Digital payment security	Scheduled Commercial Banks (excluding RRBs), Small Finance Banks, Payments Banks and credit-card issuing NBFCs are within the stated scope of RBI Digital Payment Security Controls.	Regulated entity and covered digital payment products/channels.	RBI Master Direction on Digital Payment Security Controls (18 Feb 2021)	Map applicable controls to internet/mobile/card channels; test authentication, fraud controls, monitoring and security governance.	RBI-DIGPAY
IN-CUST-01	Unauthorized electronic transactions	Banks must implement customer notification/reporting, fraud detection, immediate containment and liability/compensation handling under RBI's customer-protection direction.	Covered banks and unauthorized electronic banking transactions.	RBI circular DBR.No.Leg.BC.78/09.07.005/2017-18 (06 Jul 2017), including later entity-specific amendments	Test alert evidence, complaint acknowledgment, time-to-report rules, customer-liability decision, shadow reversal and interest/compensation.	RBI-UNAUTH
IN-PAY-01	Failed digital payment	Apply RBI turnaround-time and compensation rules for failed transactions on covered authorized payment systems.	Rail, participant and transaction specific; confirm the applicable table and latest amendments.	RBI circular on Harmonisation of TAT and customer compensation for failed transactions (20 Sep 2019)	Test timeout/failed-but-debited cases by rail, reversal deadline, compensation, value dating and exception escalation.	RBI-FAIL
IN-CX-01	Complaint escalation	Maintain internal grievance handling and escalation aligned with RBI customer-service directions and the applicable RBI Integrated Ombudsman Scheme coverage.	Entity scope under Scheme; eligibility/coverage thresholds and complaint prerequisites apply.	Reserve Bank - Integrated Ombudsman Scheme, 2021; RBI grievance redress framework	Test complaint acknowledgment, escalation timers, final response, customer notice, evidence package and external referral eligibility.	RBI-OMB; RBI-GRIEV
IN-AML-01	AML/CFT screening	Apply India's PMLA/PML Rules and RBI KYC requirements, including ongoing due diligence and applicable sanctions/prohibition list handling.	RBI-regulated entities; applicability depends on transactions and customer risk.	PMLA 2002; PML Rules 2005; RBI KYC Direction	Test list update, match handling, restrictions, escalation, reporting workflow and retention.	RBI-KYC; FATF
IN-PAY-02	Digital payment dispute	Support dispute handling and redress processes required by applicable RBI directions for relevant digital payments and payment system participants.	Product/payment system dependent.	RBI Digital Payment Security Controls; relevant payment-system directions	Test intake, status, dispute evidence, resolution outcome and rail-specific deadline/configuration.	RBI-DIGPAY; RBI-OMB

Research sources & traceability

Primary authorities and official standards used in this baseline. Source citations are linked in each catalogue row by source ID.

Source ID	Issuer	Title / relevance	Applicability caveat	Official source URL
BCP24	Basel Committee on Banking Supervision (BCBS)	Core Principles for effective banking supervision (revised 2024; effective immediately; minimum standards for sound supervision, adaptable across banking systems).	Supervisory baseline; implementation through jurisdictional frameworks; proportionate bank application.	https://www.bis.org/publications/202404-standards-core-principles-effective-banking-supervision
OPR21	BCBS	Principles for Operational Resilience (March 2021) and Principles for Sound Management of Operational Risk (revised 2021).	Principles-based guidance for banks; proportional to nature, size, complexity and risk profile.	https://www.bis.org/publications/202103-guidelines-principles-operational-resilience
CREDIT	BCBS	Basel Framework: General credit risk management; governance, underwriting, monitoring, limits and independent review.	Relevant where bank undertakes credit exposures; prudential implementation varies by jurisdiction.	https://www.bis.org/committees/bcbs/basel-consolidated-guidelines/module/cri/10
BCBS239	BCBS	Principles for effective risk data aggregation and risk reporting (2013), incorporated in Basel Framework.	Direct formal scope targets systemically important banks; broader use as a sound data/risk practice is an inference, not universal mandate.	https://www.bis.org/publ/bcbs239.pdf
FATF	Financial Action Task Force (FATF)	FATF Recommendations (international AML/CFT standard; Recommendation 10 addresses CDD and recordkeeping).	Countries implement through local laws; the standard does not create identical bank-level obligations in every jurisdiction.	https://www.fatf-gafi.org/en/publications/Fatfrecommendations/Fatf-recommendations.html
ISO22	ISO 20022 Registration Authority	ISO 20022 FAQ and message catalogue: common financial messaging definitions used by communities implementing them.	Adoption and profiles depend on payment community/scheme; ISO states no official certification authority. Not universally mandatory.	https://www.iso20022.org/faq
RBI-KYC	Reserve Bank of India (RBI)	Master Direction - Know Your Customer (KYC) Direction, 2016; RBI master-directions listing shows the direction updated as of 14 Aug 2025.	India-specific; applies to RBI-regulated entities with entity/customer conditions and amendments. Verify latest consolidation before implementation.	https://old.rbi.org.in/commonman/English/Scripts/MasterDirection.aspx
RBI-DIGPAY	RBI	Master Direction on Digital Payment Security Controls (18 Feb 2021).	India-specific; scope lists scheduled commercial banks excluding RRBs, small finance banks, payments banks and credit-card issuing NBFCs.	https://systemhealth.rbi.org.in/Scripts/BS_ViewMasDirections.aspx_id%3D12032%283%29.html
RBI-UNAUTH	RBI	Customer Protection – Limiting Liability of Customers in Unauthorised Electronic Banking Transactions (06 Jul 2017).	India-specific; scope and subsequent amendments vary by regulated entity/category.	https://www.rbi.org.in/commonman/English/scripts/Notification.aspx?Id=2623
RBI-FAIL	RBI	Harmonisation of Turn Around Time (TAT) and customer compensation for failed transactions using authorised Payment Systems (20 Sep 2019).	India-specific and payment-rail/transaction dependent; confirm current circular and applicable time table.	https://www.rbi.org.in/Scripts/NotificationUser.aspx?Id=11693
RBI-OMB	RBI	Reserve Bank - Integrated Ombudsman Scheme, 2021.	Scheme coverage is defined by entity type and thresholds; not every bank/product/complaint is necessarily in scope.	https://systemhealth.rbi.org.in/Scripts/NotificationUser.aspx_Id%3D12192%26Mode%3D0%281%29.html
RBI-GRIEV	RBI	Strengthening of Grievance Redress Mechanism in Banks (27 Jan 2021).	India-specific; circular addressed scheduled commercial banks excluding RRBs; check later applicable instructions.	https://systemhealth.rbi.org.in/Scripts/FS_Notification.aspx_Id%3D12017%26fn%3D2745%26Mode%3D0.html